

HOW TO TEST MORE

Apart from retail testing, here we highlight a few slightly more difficult, cumbersome, and technical tests that we conduct on projectors. If you have the means and access to conduct these tests inside an electronics store, by all means go ahead.

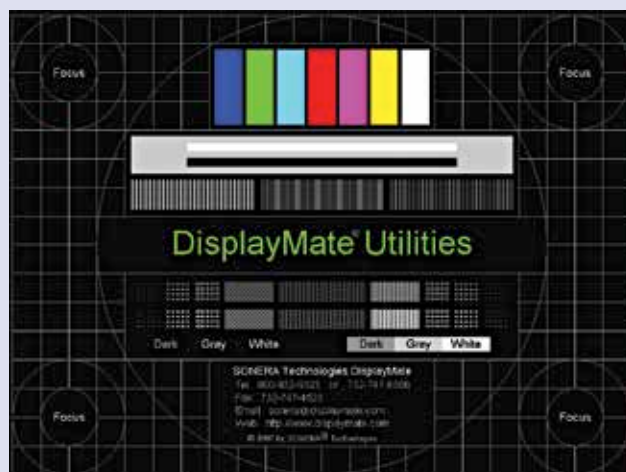
- **Light meter** - More precise than an app loaded inside a smart-phone, using a dedicated light meter (like the ones used by professional photographers) to sense ambient light falling directly



on it is one of the best way to gauge the brightness of a projector. We use the Konica Minolta light meter (as pictured alongside) to check the exact illuminance and luminosity level of the light (measured in lux, the official unit of luminance) coming out of the projector. We usually take the light reading at the screen, while keeping the

white bulb of the light meter pointed directly at the projector lens, bathed in its light. We take readings at the center of the projected image and all the four corners and average the total.

- **DisplayMate** - We use this software to not only diagnose and optimise but also test and evaluate the projector's display quality



through a series of industry recognized, widely trusted tests. Lagom.nl (www.lagom.nl) tries to capture just a fraction of the strenuous tests that DisplayMate tries to subject your projector with. Apart from checking brightness, contrast, and red, blue and green colour intensities, DisplayMate lets you test a whole host of grayscale and colour gradient tests – vertical line resolution, horizontal line resolution, colour pyramid, screen tearing, jitter, flashing etc. It's as exhaustive a test as you can put your projector through, trust us. It gets the job done spectacularly well.

flicks, or HD gaming on a console or PC – it should have a Full-HD resolution. End of discussion. Pumping in a full-HD movie from your laptop / media device and watching it squeezed down to fit into a 1280x800 or 1280x720 projector screen is nothing short of blasphemy. Say no to black bars!

4 Audio: Most, if not all, self-respecting home entertainment projectors will come with onboard speakers. But these speakers are great as a contingency option, don't look at them as the primary audio outlet to your movie-watching needs. Try as hard as they may, onboard projector speakers are just not that good – they're alright if you want



to watch a news broadcast. It's the same as expecting laptops to have great audio output – they just don't, despite however hard they try. They can never compete with a good 2.1 speaker set or a proper 5.1 audio setup. So do yourself and your ears a favour and invest in a good pair of speakers (at the very least) to go along with that spiffy new home entertainment

projector you're thinking of buying. Trust us when we say that a good audio setup goes a long way in improving your content watching experience by leaps and bounds.

5 3D: 3D is slowly coming of age not only in cinema halls and TVs but also in projectors. We'd still advise that you don't buy a projector solely based on its 3D capabilities, because eye fatigue can still kick in, no matter what. However, when you purchase a 3D-capable projector, ensure you invest in the requisite 3D glasses – active shutter or passive ones, whichever are applicable in your case – and not the cheapest ones available. Your eyesight is at stake after all, so please choose wisely. 



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